SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

WORK-LIFE BALANCE AND ITS IMPACT ON JOB SATISFACTION AMONG PORTERS: BASIS FOR COMMUNITY EXTENSION PROGRAM

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Business Management And Accountancy

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION
MAJOR IN FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

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OCTOBER 2025



CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Work-life balance is the ability of individuals to fulfill their jobs well, fulfill commitments made with family and other responsibilities, such as work and activities outside of work, as stated by Alameeri et al. 2021. For porters working at the pier, balancing work and personal life is difficult as they are responsible for carrying, assisting passengers, moving goods, luggages, cargo, and other heavy items. Many take extra jobs to meet basic needs, which affects their family responsibilities and job satisfaction. Research shows that workers who have a good work-life balance are more interested, productive, and satisfied, resulting in more flexibility and better job performance (Katebi et al., 2022; Rafic et al., 2022). Porters often work long hours in physically demanding jobs with little support, making work–life balance and job satisfaction hard to achieve. This can cause stress and burnout, especially when working hours increase or schedules are irregular (Vargas-Benitez et al., 2023). Experts believe that job satisfaction leads to motivation, loyalty, and commitment (Gazi, et al., 2024). Therefore, job satisfaction is essential for workers to be motivated and committed to their work (Vargas-Benítez et al., 2023).

In today's international landscape, work-life balance has become one of the significant impacts on job satisfaction for modern workplaces. Good balancing of health and work helps improve performance for manual workers, including porters, especially with strong organizational support (Previtali et al., 2022 and Jayaraman et al., 2023). Based on the study of Obrenovic et al., (2020) states that organizations are the ones responsible for promoting fair labor and work environments that empower workers to feel respect, support and satisfaction. The study of Chan (2020) job satisfaction for manual workers, particularly porters and other laborers, is influenced by their work–life balance and the support provided in their workplace. Companies that enforce

strategic policies and principles promoting work-life balance tend to develop dedicated and employee loyalty (Agarwal & Bhakuni, 2024). According to Gustina et al. (2025) and Susana et al. (2022) revealed that work-life balance strongly affects job satisfaction, supporting the need for a promoting work environment and improving workers productivity and retention. Agarwal and Bhakuni (2024) confirm that healthy work-life balance leads to high job satisfaction and better performance. As stated by Baxi & Atre (2024), maintaining a satisfying and motivated workplace environment is essential for consistent service quality and organizational success. When manual workers experience job satisfaction, they build happiness, loyalty, and commitment (Hidayat & Ariyanto 2021).

In the Philippines, excessive work has become a major concern in the work environment. Many employees face pressure in the workplace because of the high working demands and tension. Workers who maintain a healthier work-life balance are more productive and fulfilled with their jobs, have reduced stress, and enhanced performance (Malaki, 2024). According to Yapo (2023), due to various roles and obligations, many workers experience a high level of stress that results in specific forms of stress, such as rising turnover intent, reduced performance, lower job satisfaction, increased depression, and anxiety. Locally, there is a lack of studies on work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters, making it difficult to determine their impact. It suggests that more studies are needed to understand challenges, long-term impacts and influencing factors to support decision-making (Agarwal and Bhakuni 2024). Most studies focused only on other professions, such as teachers, office workers, and corporate employees, primarily ignoring the experiences of workers (Escarilla et al., 2025; Lagrana & Bayoneta, 2021; Dalid, 2025; Rose Lunas 2024).

The purpose of the study is to examine how the level of work-life balance experienced by the porters affects their overall job satisfaction in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. Particularly, it aims

to analyze how work demands and personal life obligations influence job contentment. Furthermore, the study seeks to identify the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction, as well as Porter's experiences regarding the existing community extension programs. By conducting this research, the results help to address problems and challenges faced by porters in maintaining work and personal lives and will serve as a basis for developing a community extension program to strengthen the quality of life and job satisfaction.

The study will be significant for various stakeholders, including porters, government/policymakers, the school/CBM department, and future researchers, to examine work-life balance and its impacts on job satisfaction among porters at Nasipit Port. Porters will directly benefit through the community extension program that can improve their working conditions and quality of life, which can lead to better health, it can reduce stress and recognize the importance of their role in the workforce. Government/Policymakers can use the results as this provide research-based evidence to support the development of labor policies, create and improve policies, benefits, and programs. The results will guide them in making fair policies and programs that protect and support workers who are ignored, especially porters. The School/CBM Department may use it as a resource for integrating work-life balance and labor-related topics into academic discussions, instruction, and community engagement projects. The results will help identify the needs of the community and guide the planning of useful and effective activities. This study will also help the department strengthen its service to the community. Lastly, future researchers will find this study valuable as it provides new information about a group that has rarely been studied in this context, providing a foundation for future studies on related topics. It also contributes to the body of knowledge on labor practices and work-life balance.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Balancing work and life are essential for employee wellness. For porters operating in a physical setting with unpredictable hours, it is important to maintain a balance between work and personal life. This chapter seeks to analyze the influence of work-life balance on job satisfaction for porters.

Work-Life Balance

Lewis and Beauregard (2018) observe that no universally accepted definition of work-life balance exists. Instead, the concept includes multiple overlapping interpretations that vary across academic literature and organizational contexts. Early research defined work-life balance as the capacity to minimize conflict between professional and personal demands. This perspective suggests that balance is achieved when individuals effectively manage both professional and personal domains, minimizing stress and preventing substantial compromise. This framework underscores the necessity of maintaining clear boundaries between occupational and personal responsibilities.

Balancing work and personal life are essential for managing a team well. When employees have work-life balance, they are more likely to stay, feel satisfied with their jobs, and help the organization succeed. However, as the way we work changes and job demands grow, it is becoming more difficult for people to keep their work and personal lives apart. Work-life balance refers to the integration of work and personal responsibilities, which contributes to overall well-being and fulfillment.

According to Bataineh (2019), achieving work-life balance depends on valuing life and striving to reach important goals. Sandhiya (Kumar, 2025) explains that the term work-life balance was introduced in 1986 as people and organizations became more aware of how work and family life can influence each other. This awareness led to the ideas of work-family conflict and family-

work conflict. The balance between work and personal life is shaped by numerous factors, both advantageous and disadvantageous. Conversely, long hours at work, elevated job demands, and family pressures can greatly hinder a person's capacity to keep a healthy equilibrium between career and personal life. Sundary (2023) talks about the balance between work and non-work situations. To find that balance, people often must set aside time from work to focus on other parts of their lives. Kasran (2023) highlights work-life balance as a state in which individuals manage their time effectively, enabling them to meet both personal and professional demands. This balance leads to a healthier lifestyle, which in turn makes employees more productive. This idea often means putting family needs first, like taking care of kids, and cutting back on work hours to keep everything in balance. Foanto (2020) emphasizes the importance of efficient time and energy management, allowing employees to effectively balance their professional and familial responsibilities. Balancing these demands makes you more resilient and more flexible, and helps you live a healthier, more sustainable life at work and at home.

Dias et al. (2022) investigated the connection between organizational commitment, job satisfaction, and work-life balance. Their result indicate that organizational commitment does not directly influence employee work-life balance but serves as a link in improving job satisfaction. The difference is especially important for porters, who usually work in high-pressure, demanding situations with little room for errors. Especially for porters who usually operate in irregular, high-pressure, and with limited autonomy. Improving the workplace with inclusive behaviors that support and acknowledge employee engagement in the workplace can increase job satisfaction regardless of difficulties of balancing work and life. Anisha and Melvin (2020) claim that inconsistencies in work-life balance can significantly affect an individual's emotional and mental health. When work takes up most of our time, it can cause stress, tiredness, and make us feel cut off from life outside the office. Keeping a healthy work-life balance helps lower stress and prevents

burnout. Ahmad Yani and M. Havidz Aima (2024) indicates that a positive work-life balance contributes to higher job satisfaction, which in turn enhances lecturers' ability to perform their Tridharma duties effectively. Furthermore, the research emphasizes the importance of human resource management interventions, such as reasonable workload distribution, clear time boundaries, and access to health and wellness resources, to support lecturers in achieving a sustainable work-life balance. A good balance also boosts motivation and job satisfaction (Al-Fatiha et al., 2021). When people believe they work for an organization that values and supports their individual needs and goals, they often perform better and are happier. This may result in increased productivity.

Adisa and Chang (2024) highlights that the balance between work and personal life is essential for employee performance as well as their well-being. It is also acknowledged as a major factor in employee productivity, satisfaction, and the overall organizational success, which makes work-life balance a vital topic in all aspects. Bellman (2021) emphasizes how flexible scheduling and remote work can affect work-life balance and job satisfaction, particularly considering changing workplace norms. Moreover, Noda, H. (2020) emphasizes that work-life balance initiatives enhance job satisfaction and contribute to sustainable productivity and long-term organizational success. Hariri et al. (2024) investigated the relationship between work-life balance and employees' overall well-being. The study found that employees who maintained a healthy balance between their professional and personal lives reported significantly higher levels of job satisfaction, reduced stress, and improved mental health. It also highlighted that flexible working arrangements, supportive management, and reasonable workload expectations were key factors that enhanced employees' well-being. Conversely, poor work-life balance was associated with burnout, lower motivation, and decreased productivity. Overall, the findings emphasized that promoting work-life balance contributes positively to both employee welfare and organizational

performance. These include job-related elements such as hours, workload, and autonomy, as well as the overall work environment, like supervisor support and company policies. Personal factors, including commitment and family responsibilities, are also significant, especially when combined with financial and social pressures. As workplaces grow faster and more competitive, maintaining a healthy work-life balance is becoming harder for many people. As modern workplaces become increasingly busy, it's often challenging to maintain a clear separation between work and personal life. This can cause stress, burnout, and a general decline in health. To be happy in both your personal and professional life, you need to find a balance between work and life. Studies show that a well-maintained work-life balance leads to happier employees, better mental health, and better performance by the organization.

Maintaining a balance between work and life can help you feel less stressed and burned out. Basuni and Sopiah (2023) reviewed many studies to understand how work-life balance affects employee burnout. Their findings showed that employees who have a good balance between work and personal life experience less stress and burnout. However, when this balance is missing, workers often feel tired, unmotivated, and emotionally drained. The authors also found that most studies focus on the problem but do not clearly explain the causes of burnout or compare different types of jobs. Also, having a good work-life balance can make you more motivated and happier at work (Al-Fatiha et al., 2021). People tend to do better and be happier when they think they work for a company that cares about their individual needs and goals. This could lead to higher productivity. Work-life balance is increasingly recognized as a critical factor in enhancing employee productivity and efficiency. Magsayo and Saguban (2024) studied public workers in Lazi, Siquijor and found that both intrinsic and extrinsic motivation are more strongly connected to work-life balance in this area than in other Southeast Asian countries. Caringal-Go and Hechanova (2022) identified eight strategies

dual-income Filipino workers use to manage work-life balance, including time management, faith, and family support. These findings suggest porters could benefit from personalized work-life balance strategies, and that community programs might help by teaching practical skills like financial planning and family engagement.

Porters frequently face similar operational and logistical challenges. These findings highlight the necessity of incorporating policy advocacy and targeted training within comprehensive support plans. Research indicates that work-life balance is a multifaceted factor critical to the health and performance of essential workers, including porters. This shows that manual laborers, including porters, often lack focus due to their irregular and limited autonomy while performing physical tasks. Dealing with this encourages fairness in the workplace and is essential, particularly for manual laborers, to support and guarantee work-life balance, which results in their job satisfaction.

Work Flexibility

Sa'adah and Sopiah (2022) characterize work flexibility as the ability of employees to determine the location and timing of their work-related tasks. Syahfitri, Absah, and Siahaan (2022) examined how employee training and the provision of facilities affect employee performance the study highlighted that work flexibility plays a key role in this relationship, as employees who can manage their work schedules alongside training and resources experience less stress and better work-life balance. This suggests that organizations can improve performance not only by developing skills and providing resources but also by allowing employees the flexibility to balance work and personal life. Ananda (2024) looked at how letting employees work more flexibly affects their ability to balance work and life, and how this in turn affects job performance. that flexible work arrangements improved work-life balance workers reported more time for family and friends, less stress and higher job satisfaction. It also found that those same flexible arrangements

led to better employee performance when compared to traditional fixed-schedule work. Experts say that Work Flexibility means that an employee can change their work hours and location as the organizations offers to make it easier for them to finish their assigned tasks. Work flexibility is increasingly recognized as a vital component of modern employment.

Febriana and Mujib (2024) find that work flexibility improves employee effectiveness and productivity, especially among Generation Z. Work schedule flexibility can significantly improve employees' overall quality of life and mental health. However, such flexibility may produce both beneficial and adverse health outcomes. Flexible work arrangements often promote improved work-life balance, a critical component of mental health, as noted by Ray and Pana-Cryan (2021).

Many organizations are now focusing more on workplace flexibility, seeing it as an important way to improve performance. When employees can shape their work environment to fit their needs, they often feel more motivated and productive.

SUPPORT FROM THE ENVIRONMENT

The presence of organizational strategies or organizational culture that allow for a better balance between employees' personal lives and their functional needs supports the work environment. The main goal of employers who promote a work culture that accommodates both family and work obligations is to increase employee engagement, which will have a harmful effect on productivity due to stress and pressure at work. Ridzuwan, Fakhri and Tenny (2025) explored how flexible working hours affect employees and organizations. They found that giving workers more control over when they work can boost things like adaptability, innovation, and job satisfaction. At the same time, the study pointed out challenges allowing flexible hours may blur the line between work and home life, make team coordination harder, and create unequal access to flexibility. They emphasize that for flexibility to really support work-life balance and performance, companies need inclusive policies, good technology, and a culture that measures

outcomes instead of just hours worked. This will not only reduce the stress but also lead to increased productivity and lower absenteeism. This reflects that organizational support is essential in creating a healthy working environment. Ezhilarasu (2025) showed that when organizations offer things like training, good facilities, flexible hours and motivational leadership, employees felt better able to handle both job demands and personal life. This supportive environment helped reduce stress and improved well-being. The study suggests that to create a healthy work-life balance, organizations must provide not just flexibility but a culture of support that makes employees feel their personal lives matter too.

Emur and Satrya (2024) highlights that employee performance is based on the organizational support and employee balance between professional and personal roles. This study suggests that when the organizations started to give support to their employees, they are ready to do any work any time without any demands. In addition to improving employee satisfaction, a positive and well-managed organizational culture also increases the organization's overall efficacy. Mohammed, Firmansyah, and Djudiyah (2024) reviewed past studies to examine how an organization’s culture affects employee engagement and productivity. They found that organizations with shared values, strong leadership, and clear communication create a supportive work environment where employees feel connected and motivated. This positive environment not only improves engagement but also increases productivity and overall performance. The authors suggest that to foster a healthy and productive workplace, companies should focus on building a culture that supports employees through aligned values, supportive leadership, and everyday practices that consider employee well-being.

Barajas (2024) argues that a strong workplace culture made up of shared values, supportive leadership, and open communication creates an environment where employees feel engaged and perform better. The article shows how culture influences how people behave, work with each

other, and commit to their job, and that when culture is positive it leads to higher productivity and stronger engagement. Barajas recommends that organizations actively shape their culture by supporting collaboration and empowerment, so employees feel connected and motivated to give their best.

To promote employee well-being and improve overall performance, an organization must have a supportive culture that values work-life balance. Businesses create an atmosphere where workers feel appreciated and empowered by implementing flexible work schedules, offering opportunities for advancement, and supporting inspirational leadership. This increases engagement, loyalty, and productivity in addition to lowering stress and absenteeism. In the end, companies that put their workers' personal and professional well-being first create the groundwork for long-term success and a vibrant workplace.

Work-Family Conflict

Work-family conflict describes a scenario where the obligations of a person's job and family life intersect, hindering the ability to meet responsibilities in either domain. This kind of conflict occurs when the demands from work and home clash, making it difficult to fulfill the requirements of one role without hindering the other. Conflict between work and family continues to be a major obstacle to attaining job satisfaction and peak performance at work. Keeping a healthy balance between work and personal duties is important for personal wellness and for preserving competitiveness in the job market. Obrenovic et al. (2020) highlight that unaddressed conflicts between work and family responsibilities can adversely affect employee performance, resulting in lower productivity and dissatisfaction with jobs. These results emphasize the significance of organizational backing in assisting employees in managing the challenges of both areas efficiently.

Shaikh (2025) examines how challenges at work and home can impact family relationships. The research shows that heavy workloads, ongoing stress, and poor communication at home may cause emotional strain and weaken family ties. In contrast, people who talk about work with their partners and spend quality time with family tend to feel better and maintain a healthier balance. The study showed that people who talked honestly with their partners about work problems and made time for family activities felt better emotionally and had a healthier balance between their job and home life. It proves that good communication and spending quality time with loved ones can really help ease the stress that comes from trying to manage both work and family duties.

When the demands of a job get in the way of responsibilities at home, it can be hard to balance both roles. This is called work-family conflict. This conflict frequently arises when professional responsibilities demand greater time, energy, or attention than familial roles can support. Not everyone can balance these two responsibilities, which can cause stress and problems between work and family life Novitasari, Sasono, and Asbari (2020). However, employees who are mentally ready to adapt and change can better cope with these conflicts, reducing their negative impact on performance. Overall, organizations that provide flexible work policies, supportive environments, and help employees balance work and family responsibilities can improve satisfaction, engagement, and productivity. Sousa and Ferro (2025) recommend that organizations support employees in combining their work and personal lives to help prevent burn out and improve fulfillment. Work-family conflict affects how safe employees feel at work and how well they perform. When work and family demands clash, employees may feel less secure and more stressed, which can lower their job performance.

Work-family conflict will continue to be a problem for manual laborers like porters, especially as the economy gets worse and work conditions get tougher. These workers will

probably have to work long hours and be physically tired, which will make I t harder for them to take care of their families. Many people will choose work over personal time because money is still a top priority. This will make them more stressed, this imbalance between work and family life will get worse if there aren't any supportive policies of flexible work arrangements. The need to work in the future to make labor protections more inclusive and understand the special problem that low-income workers face.

Job Satisfaction

Job satisfaction is now seen as a key part of how people behave and perform at work. Atre and Baxi (2024) explain that job satisfaction is shaped by a combination of internal drives, such as the need for personal growth and purpose, and external factors like fairness, recognition, and a healthy work environment. Over time, job satisfaction has proven to be a major influence on how well employees do their jobs, how loyal they are, and how successful a company can be. One of the most important factors influencing operational success is job happiness. Employees may get demotivated and affect the organization's overall performance if they are not sufficiently satisfied. According to Damayanti and Darmawan (2025) job satisfaction is the degree of contentment an individual has with their productivity, which encompasses factors like pay, working hours, workplace, and environment, as well as career advancement opportunities, interpersonal relationships, and management style. Specifically, job satisfaction acts like a boost employee who are happy with their work tend to perform better. A positive, joyful, and highly motivated attitude is exhibited by workers who enjoy their jobs Monga and Soni (2023). The authors suggest that organizations wanting to boost performance should focus on creating jobs that satisfy workers and fuel their motivation.

Employees' positive emotional reactions to their work and surroundings are related to the concept of job satisfaction. The nature of the work, compensation, relationships with coworkers,

and the overall work environment are some of the characteristics (Ali and Anwar 2021). Job satisfaction arises from a blend of emotional and environmental factors that allow individuals to genuinely feel content with their work. It reflects a responsive evaluation of actual job outcomes compared to expected results. This concept is vital because it yields significant benefits for both employees and organizations. For employees, high job satisfaction contributes to overall life happiness. For organizations, it serves as a strategic investment that can enhance performance and productivity (Sutanto, Utami, & Diantoro, 2022). Inegbedion et al. (2020) investigated the relationship between job satisfaction and employees' perceptions of workload balance. According to the study, employees' perceptions of their workloads are greatly influenced by organizational resources, duties alignment with abilities, and peer comparisons of workloads. These factors also have a significant impact on employees' job satisfaction.

For porters, fostering inclusivity and encouraging civic engagement such as teamwork, respect, and shared responsibility, can enhance a sense of belonging and fulfillment at work, leading to job satisfaction. Additionally, Licudan-Credo & Naparota (2022) found that job satisfaction is closely linked to quality of work life, with employees placing high value on respectful treatment and stable working conditions. Porters, whose roles often involve physical labor and unpredictable schedules, can significantly enhance their overall satisfaction by ensuring respectful interactions and consistent working conditions. Miller and Giblin (2023) organizations that offer benefits like flexible work schedules typically have happier and more dedicated employees. When employees had flexible working options and managers took part in leadership cohorts designed to support staff, job satisfaction improved, and staff felt a stronger sense of belonging. Similarly, Yadav and Pandita (2022) report higher levels of job satisfaction and organizational loyalty when they believe their personal and professional lives are harmoniously integrated and found that when there is good work–life integration, job contentment goes up, employees engage more with

their work, and the organization's effectiveness improves as a result. These results highlight how important it is to match workplace procedures with workers' social and family requirements to foster a more engaged and healthy work environment.

In conclusion, a variety of factors, including physical working conditions, opportunities for advancement, recognition, and compensation, influence porters' job satisfaction. Porters frequently carry out difficult and necessary duties, but when they feel appreciated, supported, and treated fairly, their sense of fulfillment can be greatly increased. In addition to raising employee morale, investments in professional development, fair pay, sufficient downtime, and improved communication also increase productivity and service quality. In the end, encouraging a more dedicated and driven workforce requires an understanding of the critical role porters play in a variety of industries.

Working Conditions

Workplace conditions have a significant impact on employee satisfaction and overall organizational performance. Research highlights various aspects of these conditions, such as the physical environment, workload, job stability, and safety protocols, as essential components in evaluating employee satisfaction in their roles. Among the various strategies aimed at enhancing labor welfare, particular emphasis is placed on improving working conditions for manual laborers, including porters. These workers often operate in physically demanding environments, such as markets, transport hubs, and construction sites, where the nature of their tasks exposes them to occupational hazards, fatigue, and social vulnerability.

(Chae, Lee, Kang, & Lee, 2024) investigates the relationship between workplace physicality and psychological factors and employee satisfaction. According to the researchers, ergonomic furniture, sufficient lighting, and easy access to resources are all examples of well-designed workspaces that have a positive impact on job satisfaction. Nonetheless, it has been

demonstrated that sociopsychological elements like recognition, work-life balance, and interpersonal relationships have an even greater influence. Higher levels of satisfaction were reported by workers who felt valued, supported by coworkers and superiors, and had flexibility in juggling work and personal obligations. By combining these variables into a predictive model, the authors found that sociopsychological factors marginally influence job satisfaction more than physical factors. Van et al. (2024) found that when employees feel their workplace supports their well-being and gives them good working conditions, their job satisfaction goes up. In turn, satisfied employees are more likely to engage deeply with their organization. The study highlights that organizations who provide healthy working environments and treat employees as valued partners help improve both the employees' experience and the organization's performance. A sense of motivation and belonging is fostered by inclusive practices, acknowledgment, and creative opportunities. According to their findings, workplace social and emotional factors have a big impact on organizational commitment and performance in addition to pay.

Porters are essential to the efficient operation of passenger and cargo transit, but they are frequently disregarded. Heavy lifting, long hours, exposure to inclement weather, and erratic schedules are all part of their job. Many porters deal with inadequate compensation, restricted access to protective gear, and little job security despite the physically demanding and logistically significant nature of their work. Access to health and safety resources, equitable compensation, and targeted labor protections are necessary to improve their working conditions. Acknowledging their contribution is important for preserving the effectiveness and humanity of port operations, not just for equity.

Compensation

Compensation is vital for influencing individual performance and enhancing overall organizational effectiveness among porters in the port. These employees frequently work under

informal agreements, facing reduced job stability and minimal benefits, rendering compensation not merely a reward but a fundamental aspect of their existence. Compensation is regarded as a key reward that employees receive in exchange for their commitment to an organization, and it serves as one of the primary strategies for enhancing employee productivity. Compensation has a significant impact on how and why people decide to work in both organizational and non-organizational settings, as noted by Adari and Satyanarayana (2018). For porters who perform manual labor, this is especially important because their physically taxing jobs frequently call for long hours and constant effort. In addition to recognizing the worth of their work, fair and sufficient compensation for these employees acts as a motivator that affects their job satisfaction and willingness to stay in their positions. Porters' morale can be greatly impacted, turnover can be decreased, and a more dedicated and effective workforce can be fostered by providing fair compensation and benefits. According to Sitorus and Hidayat (2023) examined how compensation and job satisfaction affect how productively employees at work and there is a significant and favorable correlation between employee productivity and compensation. Corresponding to their findings, employee productivity typically rises when an organization provides fair and competitive compensation. On the other hand, low or inadequate compensation may result in a drop in motivation and performance. This emphasizes how crucial it is to match pay plans with worker expectations to promote productivity, engagement, and long-term retention. It suggests that organizations aiming to boost productivity should ensure compensation is fair and balance it with efforts to improve job satisfaction through good working conditions, recognition, and employee welfare.

Organizations depend on compensation because it attracts, motivates, satisfies, and retains exceptional people. According to Reza and Faisal-E-Alam (2022), the knowledge, abilities, and skills of the workforce are essential resources for enhancing and modifying organizational

procedures to gain a competitive advantage. This observation is especially relevant to porters, who make a substantial contribution to operational effectiveness and service delivery even though they perform physically taxing jobs. Organizations can value porters' labor, promote consistent performance, and lower turnover by providing fair and competitive compensation. In addition to improving the job satisfaction of manual laborers like porters, paying them well also increases the organization's overall ability to uphold high standards and adjust to changing demand. Reddy (2020) found that fair and structured compensation matters a lot for employee performance. When workers believe their pay and benefits match their effort and role, they tend to work harder and deliver better results. It is the main requirement in human resource management which helps improve employee performance and organizational effectiveness. Compensation is something that can directly or indirectly affect the performance of working members. Various compensation components make employees feel safer working in the organization and help them meet their needs.

Sitorus and Hidayat (2023) examined the relationship between compensation, job satisfaction, and employee productivity. Their study found that both compensation and job satisfaction have a positive and significant impact on productivity. Employees who receive fair and competitive compensation are more motivated to perform well, while those who are satisfied with their jobs tend to be more engaged and committed. Organizations aiming to enhance productivity should prioritize strategic compensation practices and foster a work environment that supports employee satisfaction. For porters, fair compensation fosters a sense of job security, which is essential in environments marked by physical strain and unpredictable schedules. It also contributes to job satisfaction, reducing the likelihood of turnover and absenteeism. Employee productivity is closely tied to the compensation they receive.

Zayed et al. (2022) also emphasize that compensation serves as a key indicator of employee motivation and job satisfaction. Their study found that when employees perceive their compensation as fair and aligned with their contributions, it enhances their motivation, which in turn fosters greater job satisfaction. Satisfied employees are more likely to be engaged, committed, and productive in their roles. Porters whose roles are typically labor-intensive and time-demanding, the absence of formal compensation structured exacerbates the challenge of maintaining a healthy work-life balance. Employee productivity and compensation have a significant and positive relationship, according to Fibriadi, Yusuf, and Abduh (2022). This means that if an organization offers good compensation, employee productivity will increase, and if it offers poor compensation, employee productivity will decrease.

Overall, compensation is very important for an organization to find, keep, and motivate great people. Compensation is a critical factor in shaping employee performance and well-being, especially in informal settings where job security and benefits are limited. Fair, timely, and transparent fosters motivation, job satisfaction, and retention, while also reducing absenteeism and turnover. It enhances employee engagement and organizational effectiveness, particularly for porters, where recognition and financial stability are essential.

Community Extension Programs

Community extension programs support porters by addressing their unique challenges, such as physically demanding work and limited resources. Through skills training, financial literacy, health awareness, and social support, these programs aim to improve their well-being, work efficiency, and quality of life.

Ringconada and Eguia (2025) developed and validated a scale to measure the sustainability of community extension initiatives in Philippine state universities and colleges. The

study emphasized that sustainable programs require careful planning, consistent evaluation, and active community involvement. In relation to manual workers or porters, this suggests that well-structured extension programs such as skills training, financial literacy, and health support can improve their long-term well-being, work efficiency, and overall quality of life. Sustainable initiatives help ensure that support for porters is not temporary but continues to foster social and economic improvement over time. Olila (2021) emphasized the need for a careful and objective evaluation framework for extension projects to ensure sustainability. Well-planned community extension programs can improve community well-being while promoting social change.

This study highlights the importance of understanding work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters at Nasipit Port, a group that has received little research attention. Community extension programs play a crucial role by directly improving workers' conditions, reducing stress, promoting health, and recognizing their contributions. The findings will also support policymakers in creating fair labor policies and guide future research, while contributing to the broader knowledge on labor practices and work-life balance.

Age

Age will continue to significantly influence how individuals manage their work-life balance. Future research and existing projections indicate that each generation will encounter distinct challenges and will adopt varying strategies to address them. For instance, the International Labour Organization (2023) reported that younger workers will be more likely to work longer hours and experience lower job security; as a result, they will find it more difficult to maintain a healthy balance between work and personal life. In contrast, older workers will increasingly seek employment that offers both stability and flexibility to match their evolving

physical, family, and lifestyle needs. Thus, age will remain a crucial factor in shaping how employees perceive and manage their work-life balance.

Fernandez and Lebin (2022) will provide valuable insights that will be particularly relevant to porters, whose physically demanding roles will further emphasize the importance of age-sensitive work-life balance strategies. Specifically, younger porters will tend to value flexible work shifts that will allow them to develop skills and explore personal interests. Meanwhile, older porters will benefit more from ergonomic tools, manageable workloads, and comprehensive employment benefits, all of which will help sustain their health, productivity, and overall job satisfaction. Similarly, Gumpal and Cardenas (2021) will suggest that Filipino workers' perceptions of work-life balance will continue to be shaped by generational differences. Their findings will indicate that both Baby Boomers and Millennials will prioritize harmony between work and personal life; however, the emphasis they will place on each domain will shift as responsibilities and life stages change. In the context of porters, whose work will require physical endurance and extended working hours, these generational distinctions will become especially significant. For example, Baby Boomers and Millennials will generally favor stable routines and health security, whereas Generation X workers will prefer greater flexibility to accommodate changing personal and professional priorities.

Overall, particularly in physically demanding occupations such as portering, age will remain a defining factor in how workers will experience and manage work-life balance. Despite this, a notable gap will persist in how organizations will translate generational preferences into effective workplace policies. Although awareness will continue to increase, many institutions will still rely on one-size-fits-all approaches that will fail to address the diverse and nuanced needs of different age groups. Consequently, by recognizing and responding to these generational

distinctions, organizations will be able to foster a more balanced, resilient, and age-inclusive workforce.

Gender

Gender will continue to play a significant role in shaping individuals' experiences of work-life balance and career advancement. In this regard, Malap and Mungekar (2024) will examine the influence of traditional gender roles on work-life balance, emphasizing that men historically perceived as primary breadwinners will increasingly become more involved in household responsibilities. Nevertheless, societal expectations will persist in pressuring men to prioritize their careers, which will result in a continuing imbalance between their professional and personal lives.

Similarly, Pace and Sciotto (2021) will identify notable gender differences in work-life balance and career outcomes. Their study will indicate that women will often perceive fewer opportunities for career advancement and will report poorer health outcomes when work-life balance is disrupted. In contrast, men will tend to benefit from more flexible work arrangements, which will contribute to better health and higher levels of job satisfaction. Based on these findings, work-life balance policies will need to account for the distinct needs of different gender groups. By doing so, organizations will be able to promote equal opportunities for career growth and overall well-being across the workforce.

These results are especially important for male porters, who may hide their emotional stress because of what society expects of them, which makes them more likely to burn out. Extension programs should actively work to make mental health support normal, especially for male porters. They should create spaces where emotional well-being is important, and people are encouraged to ask for help.

Income

The Philippines Labour Market Profile (2025) provides a sobering view of economic conditions faced by manual laborers, particularly porters and other informal workers. The report notes that many workers, particularly students and young adults, rely on manual labor to support their families. This is common in urban areas and transport hubs, where physically demanding jobs are available without informal qualifications. Workers in the informal sector usually make less than the national average and miss out on benefits like health insurance, paid leave, or retirement plans since they do not have formal contracts.

The Philippines Statistics Authority's Income and Expenditure Survey (2025) shows that manual labor roles, such as portering, are mainly found in lower income groups. The Philippine Social Science Council's Family Income and Expenditure Survey (2021) shows that regions such as Caraga have much lower average incomes than the National Capital Region. According to Al-Mamari (2024), people with higher incomes often have flexible work options and supportive policies that help them manage stress and maintain a healthy work-life balance. In contrast, those with lower incomes usually have strict schedules and less control over their time, making it harder to balance work and personal life. This research highlights how economic factors shape work-life quality and shows why it is important for workplaces to support the well-being of all employees, no matter their income level.

For manual laborers, including porters, income serves as the principal means of sustaining their livelihoods. These workers often work long hours in tough conditions and usually have little job security. Their income provides for essential needs such as nutrition, influences the level of familial support available, determines access to healthcare services, and impacts opportunities for rest. A lot of porters must put their health on hold because they don't always make enough money.

Relationship Status

Studies suggest that people who are married or in a relationship often experience better work-life balance because they can share responsibilities and support each other at home. For manual workers in demanding, low-income jobs, having a stable relationship may help reduce work-related stress. Recent demographic shifts necessitate a detailed examination of variations in work-life satisfaction across distinct relationship-status groups. Previous studies have often overlooked these differences and treated all unmarried groups as the same (Kislev, 2019; Sassler & Lichter, 2020). Kislev (2022) emphasizes that although single people might not have the conventional obligations linked to family life like raising children, supporting a partner, or managing a household, they remain vulnerable to work-life conflict.

Previous studies show that extra work can be as difficult for single workers as for those who are married. This suggests we should examine how workload affects people with different relationship statuses. Culpepper et al. (2020) point out that single individuals are often underrepresented in work-life balance (WLB) research, even though numerous studies have shown that increased workload consistently lowers WLB satisfaction levels (Dyrbye et al., 2020; Johari et al., 2018). Some research shows that the negative effects of heavy workloads are similar for both single and married workers. Some believe that single workers are better equipped to handle work demands than those who are married. Porters often have difficult jobs with little legal protection. They work long hours, have unpredictable schedules, and get little rest. Consequently, both single and married porters experience significant challenges in maintaining equilibrium between occupational responsibilities and personal life. For married porters, demanding workloads frequently strain familial relationships and limit opportunities for family engagement. In contrast, single porters often experience social isolation, reduced emotional support, and limited opportunities for leisure or personal development. These conditions

collectively impede the attainment of a healthy work-life balance. Furthermore, evolving societal attitudes toward relationships have influenced how workers navigate professional responsibilities and personal lives. Family situations shape how people balance work and personal life, especially when strong support systems are not available.

The Philippines Statistics Authority, there were 414,213 legally recognized marriages in 2023. This is a drop of 7.8% from 2022. This drop is part of a larger trend in the country where people are living together and putting off marriage, especially low-income workers who can't afford to get married. Informal partnerships often lack institutional support or legal safeguards, and these evolving relationship dynamics influence work-life balance by altering individuals' management of familial and professional obligations. Various family arrangements affect how people balance.

Years of Experience

Years of experience are very important for achieving a good work-life balance. Employees who have been with an organization for numerous years tend to develop more effective strategies for managing stress and heavy workloads. According to Thilagavathy and Geetha (2023), manual laborers often experience high levels of physical strain and limited flexibility, making it challenging for them to balance their personal and professional lives. Bello and Tanko (2020) added that years of experience can help these workers develop better coping strategies and boundary-setting skills, which will help them deal with stress and role conflict more effectively.

According to the World Economic Forum (2025), flexibility and experience at work are important for maintaining a healthy work-life balance. Workers with more tenure typically report lower levels of burnout and greater life satisfaction. These findings suggest that extended employment duration and organizational support are critical factors in enhancing employee

satisfaction. It also suggests that work-life balance strategies should be tailored to different levels of individual experience.

To sum up, experience plays a key role in how manual laborers like porters manage their work and personal lives. As people gain more professional experience, they become better at handling physical demands, setting clear boundaries at work, and dealing with job-related stress.

Educational Attainment

Educational attainment refers to the highest level of education completed by the porters. Understanding their educational background helps identify how education may influence their work performance, job satisfaction, and ability to balance work and personal life. It provides context for analyzing their needs and challenges in the workplace. Unskilled manual workers often face challenges that affect their psychological well-being, and education plays an important role in this.

Park and Kim (2021) found that unskilled manual workers with lower education experience lower job satisfaction, reduced support from supervisors, and more negative work environments, which can lead to stress and diminished well-being; importantly, it is the combination of low education and difficult working conditions not manual labor itself that drives these outcomes, suggesting that improving educational access and workplace support can enhance mental health and job satisfaction. Similarly, Vyas (2022) highlighted how the COVID-19 pandemic reshaped work environments, noting that highly educated workers often occupy roles that allow for remote or hybrid arrangements, providing better flexibility and work-life balance, while less-educated workers remain in physically demanding jobs with limited adaptability, higher job insecurity, and lower wages; reskilling and upskilling initiatives are therefore critical to reducing inequality and supporting these workers' well-being. In the context of labor migrants and porters, Mahato and Paudel (2023) emphasize that higher education and specialized training

equip workers to perform tasks more efficiently, safely, and confidently, while limited education restricts professional growth and adaptability, enhancing access to education and skills development can improve competence, productivity, and career opportunities even in physically demanding roles, reinforcing the international evidence that knowledge and training significantly influence work outcomes and overall well-being.

The Labor Force Survey (LFS, 2022) shows that individuals with lower educational attainment are more likely to experience unemployment, underemployment, and end up in low-skilled, physically demanding jobs. This directly reflects the situation of porters, whose work depends more on physical labor than formal qualifications. With limited education, many porters have fewer opportunities for stable employment or career advancement, making them more vulnerable to informal, irregular, and low-income work conditions common in manual labor sectors. The World Bank Philippine Jobs Report (2023) suggests that workers with low educational attainment like many porters and manual laborers are more likely to stay in low-wage, informal, and physically demanding jobs with limited mobility. Because their skills do not match the requirements of more productive sectors, they face fewer opportunities for better employment and are more vulnerable during economic disruptions. Improving education and skills training is therefore essential to help porters move toward more stable and higher-quality jobs.

Educational attainment significantly shapes the work conditions and opportunities of porters, as those with lower education face greater job insecurity, limited mobility, and reduced well-being. Enhancing access to education, training, and skill development is essential to improving their job satisfaction, safety, and long-term career prospects.

Number of Children

This is an important demographic factor that helps explain the personal and economic pressures faced by porters or manual workers. Workers with more children often carry greater

financial responsibilities and may experience increased stress in balancing work and family needs. This can influence their work-life balance, job satisfaction, and overall well-being. Understanding how family size affects porters' daily lives provides useful context for interpreting their challenges, priorities, and the support they may need in both their work and personal environments.

Haar et al. (2019) found that family demands reduce work-life balance, indicating that workers with greater responsibilities, such as raising children, experience more difficulty balancing work and home life. Although the study did not focus on manual workers or porters, its findings suggest that employees engaged in physically demanding jobs and receiving limited support may experience additional strain on their work-life balance when they have more children, unless strong workplace support mechanisms are available. Similarly, Guo et al. (2025) reported that the number of children was a key predictor of fertility intention, with workers who already had more children being less likely to plan for additional ones. Other significant factors included age, marital status, monthly income, self-perceived economic status, and social support. Taken together, these findings imply that for manual workers such as porters who often face heavy workloads and lower income levels the presence of existing children may substantially reduce the likelihood of planning for more, while also intensifying challenges related to work–life balance.

The number of children significantly shapes the personal and economic pressures faced by porters and manual workers. Larger family responsibilities can intensify stress, reduce work-life balance, and influence decisions about having more children, especially for low-income workers with physically demanding jobs. This highlights the need for adequate workplace and social support to help these workers manage both their professional and family obligations effectively.

Other Means of Income

Porters often supplement their earnings through other sources of income due to the unpredictable nature of port work. These alternative income-generating activities may include providing additional services to passengers, running small side businesses, or helping with logistics for private clients. Such sources of income enable porters to improve financial stability and support their families despite the demands of their occupation.

Recent studies show that Filipino workers, especially those in informal jobs such as manual laborers and porters, face many challenges in earning a stable income. Ipsos (2025) reports that gig workers often rely on multiple income sources to survive, and the same is true for manual workers and porters who may take on additional jobs, engage in small-scale businesses, or depend on family support through remittance to meet their needs. Similarly, the World Bank (2022) highlights that low-skilled and informal workers are particularly vulnerable to poverty and inequality, often relying on remittances, domestic transfers, or side jobs to sustain their households. Misra, Kumari, and Sajid (2024) emphasize that the informal sector provides crucial employment opportunities, allowing workers to cope with limited formal work options, though these jobs often lack security and benefits. Fairwork Philippines (2023) also notes that platform and informal workers face risks to their health, safety, and financial stability, underlining the importance of additional income sources to manage these uncertainties.

Overall, these studies suggest that manual workers and porters depend not only on their primary income but also on other income sources to survive, highlighting their economic vulnerability and the importance of flexible earning strategies.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Maslow's theory suggests that human motivation follows a hierarchy, starting from basic physiological and safety needs, advancing to social belonging, esteem, and ultimately self-actualization (Maslow, 1943). In the workplace, this implies that employees must first have job stability, a safe working environment, and support to manage work-family conflicts before pursuing higher-level goals like personal development and work-life balance. Flexible work options, as highlighted by Robbins and Judge (2020), help meet these essential psychological needs. Additionally, organizations that promote independence, creativity, and responsibility can enable employees to reach fulfillment and excellence (Maslow, 1968). For porters, who face physically demanding tasks and irregular schedules, interventions like flexible scheduling and community-based support can help them balance work and personal life, enhancing overall satisfaction and motivation.

Maslow's hierarchy remains highly relevant to understanding work-life balance and job satisfaction. Alkema (2024) explains that employees are less motivated to engage in higher-level activities until their basic needs are met. Tanner (2025) supports this, noting that motivation and satisfaction are closely tied to how well an individual fulfills each need. Greenhaus and Allen (2011) emphasize that unresolved work-family conflict undermines psychological safety and belonging lower-tier needs in Maslow's hierarchy which in turn reduces motivation and engagement. Ensuring that employees' basic needs are addressed allows them to pursue higher-level objectives, including self-esteem and self-actualization, which are linked to work-life balance and overall well-being.

Despite its usefulness, Maslow's theory has limitations. It assumes a linear progression through the hierarchy, which may not accurately reflect real-life experiences, especially for

porters who might prioritize safety, belonging, financial security, or respect differently based on circumstances. The theory does not fully capture the variability in individual motivation, nor does it account for cultural or situational factors that influence needs. Nevertheless, it remains a valuable framework for designing workplace interventions that enhance both basic and higher-level employee needs, providing a foundation for programs that improve work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Created by Frederick Herzberg (1959), the Two-Factor Theory was also referred to as the Motivation-Hygiene Theory, differentiating between hygiene factors and motivators as essential influences of job satisfaction (Herzberg, Mausner, & Snyderman, 1959). Hygiene factors encompass aspects like compensation and stable working conditions. Conversely, motivators like acknowledgment, career growth opportunities**,** and personal development are inherent to the role and result in increased satisfaction when they are available (Nickerson, 2024; Kincaid, 2025).

Growth opportunities, accomplishment, and meaningful work are intrinsic motivators that encourage employee engagement and satisfaction, according to (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2023). Compensation, job security, and working conditions, on the other hand, are classified as hygiene factors aspects that are necessary to avoid dissatisfaction. Herzberg's theory helps explain why porters, who often do physical labor, work long hours, and have few chances to advance in their jobs, could be unhappy with their jobs even if others of them are fine. On the other hand, porters are happier at work when they are given chances to grow and be recognized. This is in line with the recent research in workplace psychology that has found both characteristics are important for making a work environment that is productive and satisfying. Organizations that actively recognize employee contributions and offer clear career development pathways foster greater affective commitment, assert Zhu Jia-jun & Song Hua-ming (2022). Overall organizational

loyalty and performance are improved by this emotional connection between workers and their place of employment. According to their research, workers are more likely to be content with their positions and stick with them when they feel supported by their organizations and have opportunities for professional development. Developing a theoretical framework that connects intrinsic motivation to job satisfaction and long-term retention requires this understanding.

This study explores how work-life balance and job satisfaction, while related, uniquely affect employee well-being. Work-life balance encompassing flexibility, supportive environments, and managing work-family conflict helps employees maintain stability between work and personal life. Job satisfaction, in contrast, involves factors like career growth, fair pay, and good working conditions. According to Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, porters often focus first on basic needs such as safety, security, and sufficient income before seeking higher-level fulfillment. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory further explains that work-life balance can serve as both a hygiene factor, preventing dissatisfaction, and a motivator, promoting engagement and satisfaction. Enhancing both aspects can therefore improve motivation and overall well-being.

Research supports the connection between these theories and Quality of Work Life. A study in the *International Journal for Multidisciplinary Research* (2024) emphasizes that career progression, work-life balance, and fair compensation directly influence employee satisfaction. Al-Omari et al. (2020) identify work flexibility, supportive environment, work-family conflict, and growth opportunities as key dimensions affecting satisfaction, alongside working conditions and compensation. These variables guide the current study on porters in the hospitality sector, linking Maslow's focus on basic and social needs with Herzberg's distinction between hygiene factors and motivators.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

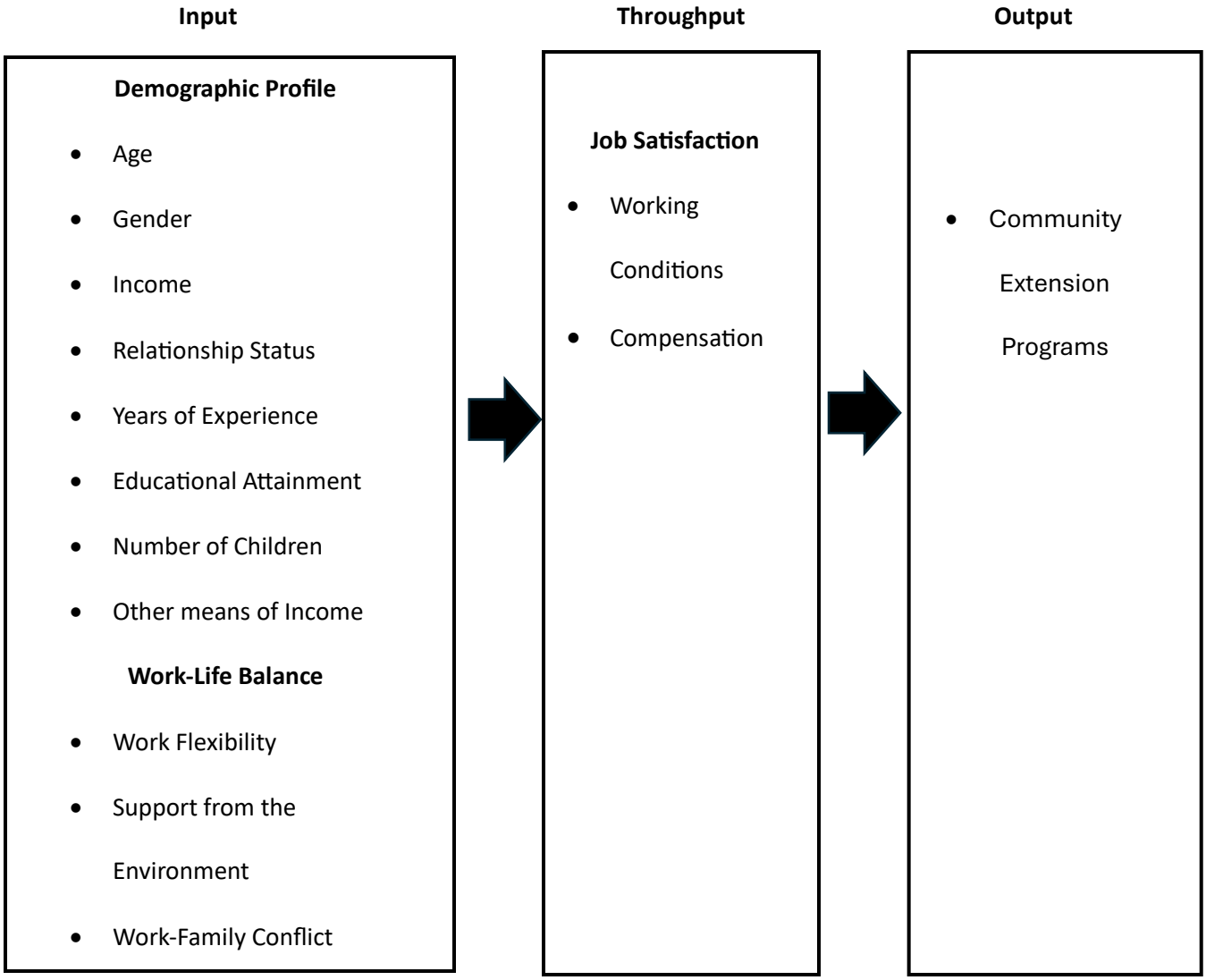


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the interplay between the input, throughput, and output of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

This study seeks to explore the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters and to answer the questions outlined below:

1. What is the demographic profile of Porters in terms of:

    1.1 age;

    1.3 gender;

    1.4 income;

    1.5 relationship status;

    1.6 years of experience;

    1.7 educational attainment;

    1.8 number of children; and

    1.9 other means of income

2. To what extent does the impact of work-life balance among porters in terms of:

    2.1 work flexibility.

    2.2 support from the environment;

    2.3 work-family conflict

3. To what extent does the impact of job satisfaction among porters in terms of:

    3.1 working conditions;

    3.2 compensation

4. Is there a significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters?

5. What community extension program can be proposed to enhance the work-life balance and Job satisfaction among porters?

1.6 Hypothesis

Null Hypothesis (H_o)

There is no significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1)

There is a significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study will examine the work-life balance and its impact on job satisfaction among porters at Talisay Port in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, particularly those employed as laborers will assist passengers with their luggage. The research, which will be conducted during the 2025-2026 academic year, aims to understand the unique challenges faced by porters, including physically demanding duties, irregular working hours, inadequate rest, and the pressure of managing familial responsibilities. The study will seek to establish baseline data for a community extension program that will enhance well-being and will encourage sustainable livelihood practices by analyzing the impact of these factors on job satisfaction.

The data will be gathered using survey questionnaires that the porters will answer personally, making sure that the results will be based on their own experiences and points of view. The study will also lay the groundwork for creating a community extension program that will promote improved quality of life and will support environmentally sustainable livelihood practices. The study will be limited to porters at Talisay Port, which may limit the applicability of the findings to other ports or labor sectors. Only those who will be available and willing to participate in the data collection will be included in the study.

1.8 Definition of Terms

The following important terms are defined as they are used in the context of this research to guarantee clarity and consistency throughout the study.

Age. Referring to the number of complete years an individual has lived since birth, as reported by the respondent at the time of data collection and measured in years.

Community Extension Program. An initiative that uses the findings on porters' work-life balance and job satisfaction to design programs or activities that improve their well-being, working conditions, and overall quality of life.

Compensation. Payment and benefits that porters receive for performing tasks.

Educational Attainment. The highest level of education a porter has completed.

Gender. Identities associated with being male, female, or another identity.

Income. The total earnings of porters from their work and other sources, measured to determine its relationship with their work-life balance and job satisfaction.

Job Satisfaction. Referring to how Porter's content and fulfilled they feel with their work, including their duties, treatment, compensation, and overall work environment.

Number of Children. The total count of a porter's biological or legally adopted children, used to examine its effect on their work-life balance and job satisfaction.

Other means of Income. Refers to any additional source of earnings aside from a porter's main job, such as small businesses, sideline activities, part-time work, or remittances received from family members working abroad.

Porters. Workers in port areas who assist travelers and passengers by carrying, loading, and unloading personal luggage are responsible for safely and efficiently moving bags from vehicles and helping passengers throughout the check-in process.

Relationship Status. A person's current romantic or family situation. It shows whether someone is single, married, in a relationship, separated, divorced, or widowed.

Support from the Environment. Referring to the assistance porters receive from their workplace surroundings, including cooperation from coworkers, understanding from supervisors, and access to resources that help them do their job effectively and with less stress.

Work Flexibility. The degree to which porters can adjust their work schedules to meet personal needs and preferences, measured to assess its impact on their work-life balance and job satisfaction.

Work-Family Conflict. The extent to which porters experience clashes between job demands and home responsibilities, making it difficult to maintain a balance between work and family life.

Work-life Balance. The porter's ability to manage physically demanding and irregular work duties while maintaining sufficient time and energy for personal and family life.

Working Conditions. Referring to the environmental factors that affect how porters do their jobs, where workers stay healthy, safe, and productive.

Years of Experience. The total length of time a porter has spent working in a specific job, and how long the individual has been performing their duties.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This section provides an overview of the techniques used for gathering data and analyzing pertinent research findings. The methods that were discussed include the research design, research locale, research respondents, research instrument, and ethical standards, data gathering procedures, and data analysis plan and procedures.

2.1 Research Design

This study will adopt a quantitative descriptive-correlational research design to explore the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. The descriptive component will provide a clear profile of porters' work-life balance practices and levels of job satisfaction, presenting frequencies, means, and distributions to capture the overall patterns in the data. The correlational aspect will then examine measurable associations between the two variables, determining the strength and direction of their relationship without manipulating any conditions. Data will be collected through survey questionnaires and analyzed using appropriate statistical techniques. Findings from this study will not only describe the current state of work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters but also inform the development of targeted community extension programs that address their specific needs and challenges.

2.2 Research Locale

The study will be conducted at the Port of Nasipit, located in Barangay Talisay, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, a 1st class municipality in the Caraga Region of the Philippines. Strategically situated along Butuan Bay, Nasipit serves as a major gateway for both cargo and passenger movement, connecting the region to key Philippine islands such as Cebu, Bohol, and Luzon. The port is designated by the Philippine Ports Authority (PPA) as an International Base Port, handling

significant volumes of roll-on/roll-off (RORO) and lift-on/lift-off (LOLO) cargo, as well as passenger ferry operations throughout the year. The port contributes substantially to the local economy by facilitating the transport of agricultural products, industrial goods, and consumer supplies, while ongoing infrastructure projects aim to enhance its capacity and efficiency. The municipality is currently governed by Mayor Roscoe Democrito B. Plaza, whose administration oversees economic development initiatives, community welfare programs, and infrastructure improvements. Within this setting, the Nasipit Porters Organization a group of porters responsible for carrying, loading, unloading, and transporting goods provides a relevant population for examining work-life balance, job satisfaction, and related socioeconomic concerns, due to the physically demanding nature of their work, irregular schedules, and pivotal role in port operations.

2.3 Research Respondents

The respondents of this study will be the 40 porters working at Nasipit Port in Talisay, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines. Given the relatively small population size, the study will employ Complete Enumeration Sampling, ensuring that all members are included to comprehensively capture their collective experiences. This approach will allow the researcher to obtain accurate and representative findings that reflect the realities of port work. These porters will be directly engaged in cargo handling and passenger assistance, tasks that are physically demanding and place them in unique working conditions. Their experiences will be crucial to understanding the challenges and realities of port labor, particularly since this group has been largely overlooked in previous studies. The porters will not be formally employed by Nasipit Port itself; instead, they will operate under their own organization, the Porters Organization, which will manage their work arrangements and representation. This independent status will distinguish them from other port workers and highlight the need to examine their specific working conditions and well-being.

Table 1. Respondents of the study

RESPONDENTS	POPULATION	FREQUENCY	PERCENTAGE
Nasipit Porters	40	40	100%

The table shows the total population of porters working at Nasipit Port.

2.4 Research Instrument

This study will used a modified survey questionnaire as its primary research instrument to gather quantitative data on the work-life balance and job satisfaction of porters at Nasipit Port that integrates Paul E. Spector's Job Satisfaction Survey (JJS, 1985) provides a reliable framework for measuring key dimensions of job satisfaction using a standardized Likert-scale format and the study of Dr. Vinod Damodar Malap and Prof. Dr. Pratik Rajan Mungkar, Work-Life Balance: A Gendered Perspective (2024) by addressing how gender roles influence the balance between professional and personal life.

The survey questionnaire consist of three parts: (1) the demographic profile of the respondents, including age, gender, income, relationship status, years of experience, educational attainment, number of children, and other means of income; (2) items measuring the work-life balance including work flexibility, support from the environment, and work-family conflict; (3) items measuring the impact of job satisfaction, including working conditions and compensation. These parts of the survey questionnaire will examine the impact of work-life balance on job satisfaction among porters. The instrument used a Likert scale format to measure the degree of agreement with each statement.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This study did not encompass the creation of new technologies, processes, and products necessitating patent protection. The research instrument employed to evaluate the work-life

balance and its impact on job satisfaction among porters was created by a different author and is used with formal authorization. The research also did not include any unique branding elements, like a logo or symbol.

B. Informed Consent

All respondents in the study were provided with informed consent forms that explained the research objectives. The research procedures involve answering a survey questionnaire. All the information collected will be kept completely private and only used for academic and program development purposes. No reports or publications will include any information that could be used to identify someone personally. The study presents no identifiable risks to participants, and although direct benefits may not be immediate, the findings may enhance support systems for porters.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

In accordance with ethical standards, the researchers will maintain and protect the confidentiality of the participants, and their identities will not be disclosed at any stage of the research. The data that will be collected will be securely stored and will be accessed exclusively by the researchers for academic and program development purposes. Personal information will not be shared with any other parties, and the results will be reported in a manner that will ensure individual participants cannot be identified. Furthermore, the findings of the study will be presented rather than individually, to avoid biases and prevent direct comparisons among participants.

D. Voluntary Participation

In this study, the respondents were volunteers. Individuals invited to take part are under no obligation to participate and may decline or withdraw from study at any point without facing

any form of penalty of loss of benefits. The researchers will respect each participant's autonomy and decision throughout the research process.

E. Minimization of Harm

The research will be designed to avoid any physical, psychological, social, or legal risks, and participants will not undergo procedures that will cause discomfort, with all survey responses remaining private for academic use only. To ensure understanding, the questionnaires will be translated into Bisaya, and surveys will be completed at the participants' workplace with sufficient time provided to minimize disruption to duty hours. Participants will be free to skip any question or withdraw at any time without consequences, and for those who will be temporarily absent from their work areas, the researchers will coordinate with their head to arrange a suitable time for completion. The researchers will maintain a respectful and supportive environment, and they will protect the dignity, rights, and well-being of all participants. The reporting of results will have limitations, as the findings of the study will be presented rather than individually, to avoid biases and prevent direct comparisons among participants, thereby ensuring fairness and integrity in the interpretation of the data.

F. Beneficence

The researchers are committed to conducting the study in a manner that promotes the well-being of all participants, aiming to generate insights that can lead to meaningful improvements in their work-life conditions. The study is designed to avoid any form of harm and to minimize potential benefits, particularly through the development of a community extension program that addresses the specific needs of porters. By participating, individuals contribute to a research initiative that seeks to enhance job satisfaction, support personal well-being, and foster a more balanced and productive work environment.

G. Justice and Fair Participants Selection

The study will adhere to the ethical principle of justice by ensuring fair and equitable treatment of all participants. All porters at Nasipit Port are included in the study, as their involvement is essential to achieving the research objectives. No participant is excluded based on age, gender, ethnicity, religion, or socioeconomic status. This approach promotes inclusiveness and respects the dignity, rights, and contributions of all participants.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researcher used clear and organized methods to ensure accurate and consistent data collection and analysis. All data collected will be recorded, analyzed, and reported with honesty, transparency, and precision. The researchers commit to avoiding any form of data fabrication, falsification, or misrepresentation. Responses will be transcribed and encoded faithfully, ensuring that the findings reflect the true experiences and perspective of the participants. Any errors identified during the research process will be promptly corrected, and all procedures will be conducted in accordance with established academic and ethical standards and the credibility of the study.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The researchers commit to presenting findings honestly, clearly, and without distortion. All methodologies, data analyses, and results will be documented accurately and disclosed in full, ensuring that interpretations are based on the verifiable evidence. Any limitations, potential biases, or conflicts of interest will be openly acknowledged to maintain the integrity of the research. The final report will reflect the true outcomes of the study and will be made available to stakeholders, participants, and relevant institutions to promote accountability and informed decision-making.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

All resources, tools, and references utilized by the researcher, such as published articles, survey instruments, will be properly cited and used in accordance with intellectual property laws. No copyrighted content will be reproduced without permission, and any materials requiring authorization will be obtained before use. The researchers commit to respecting the rights of original creators and ensuring that all borrowed content is acknowledged to maintain academic integrity and avoid infringement.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animals and Human Trials

This study only involves human participants and does not include any form of animal testing. The researchers ensure that all procedures involving human subjects strictly adhere to ethical guidelines for research, including respect for autonomy, informed consent, confidentiality, and the minimization of harm. Participants are selected fairly and treated with dignity throughout the research process. The study has been designed to ensure that no physical, psychological, or social risks are imposed on individuals, and all data will be handled with integrity and transparency.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

The researchers used AI tools such as Quillbot and Grammarly; these platforms were utilized to enhance the clarity, coherence, and grammatical accuracy of the research. Their use was limited to language refinement and did not alter the original meaning, data interpretation, or integrity of the findings. The researchers ensured that all content remained authentic, and that the use of AI tools complied with ethical standards for academic purposes. Proper citations and acknowledgments were maintained throughout to uphold transparency and intellectual honesty.

M. Ethical Approval

The Institutional Review Board (IRB) of Saint Michael College of Caraga will review and approve the study titled Work-Life Balance and Its Impact on Job Satisfaction Among Porters: Basis

for Community Extension Program. This approval will affirm the study's adherence to ethical standards concerning participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights. Through the IRB process, the rights and welfare of respondents will be safeguarded, ensuring that the research will be conducted with integrity, transparency, and respect for all ethical considerations.

N. Disposal

All data collected from participants, including questionnaires and digital records, will be securely stored for the duration of the study. After the completion of the research and any required reporting, physical documents will be shredded, and digital files will be permanently deleted to ensure confidentiality. No personal identifiers will be retained beyond the study period, safeguarding participants' privacy in accordance with ethical research standards.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedures

The researchers followed these procedures in gathering data.

Permission to Conduct the Study: The researchers will send a formal letter requesting permission to conduct the study to the head of porters in Talisay, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. The letter will be noted by the research adviser and approved by Dean Russellene B. Coraza of the College of Business Management, Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Orientation to participants: Before distributing the questionnaires, the researchers will conduct an orientation with all participating porters at their designated work area within Nasipit Port. During this session, the purpose of the study will be explained, emphasizing voluntary participation, anonymity, and the right to skip questions or withdraw at any time without consequences. The researchers will also provide instructions on how to complete the questionnaire to ensure that participants fully understand each item and feel comfortable sharing

their experiences. The porters will then answer the questionnaire in Talisay Gym, providing a suitable and organized environment for data collection.

Distribution of Questionnaire: The questionnaires were distributed personally to each porter at their workplace within Nasipit Port. Respondents were given approximately 30 minutes to complete the questionnaire on the spot, minimizing disruption to their regular duties while allowing sufficient time for thoughtful responses. The researchers were available during the entire process to clarify any questions and help as needed.

Gathering of Questionnaires: Upon completion, the researchers collected the questionnaires immediately to maintain confidentiality and ensure data security. Each response was checked individually to confirm completeness and accuracy.

Consolidating Data: The collected data were tabulated, organized, and checked for consistency. With the assistance of a statistician, the data were analyzed using appropriate statistical tools to generate insights on the relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters.

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedures

Statistical treatment will make the collected data easier to interpret and analyze. This will be the stage where researchers will analyze their data, formulate conclusions, and make informed decisions.

The researchers analyzed and interpreted the data using the following statistical tools.

Frequency and Percentage: This tool will be used to answer the first problem, which focuses on determining the demographic profile of porters in terms of age, gender, income, relationship status, years of experience, educational attainment, number of children, and other means of income. The distribution of respondents across each category will be clearly presented by

frequency and percentage, which will help in understanding the diversity and background of the porter population.

Weighted Mean: The mean was used to address Problems 2 and 3, which focused on examining the extent of work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. Providing a focus on work flexibility, support from the environment, work-family conflict, working conditions, and compensation, the mean was utilized to assess the influence of work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. It helped evaluate how these factors affected their performance and well-being by providing a clear average of responses.

Pearson's Correlation: Spearman Rho Correlation was used to address Problem 4, which examined the significant relationship between work-life balance and job satisfaction among porters. This statistical tool supported in determining the relationship between ranked variables, including compensation, working conditions, career growth opportunities, work-family conflict, work flexibility, and support the environment. By examining these connections, Spearman Rho Correlation demonstrated whether increases in work-life balance were associated with greater job satisfaction, providing important information about how these elements interact to affect porter performance and well-being.

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